

Kyle Prestenback

Henderson, NV
(818) 568-7498 kyle.prestenback@gmail.com

PROFILE

Senior themed-entertainment and location-based experience executive with 20+ years leading complex creative, technical, operational, and commercial programs from strategy through delivery. Known for moving fluidly between executive strategy and delivery detail—earning trust across clients, senior stakeholders, and project teams by coaching leaders, resolving complex issues, and staying close enough to the work to unblock execution. Experience spans Walt Disney Imagineering, Carnival Corporation, Wynn Resorts, and entrepreneurial ventures, including executive leadership of an approximately \$1B fleet-wide transformation.

ENTREPRENEURIAL & OPERATING LEADERSHIP

Dusty Cupboard Company – Founder / Executive Producer **2021 to Present**

- Founded and developed Next Byte, a social location-based entertainment and hospitality concept; secured approximately \$1M in project financing and negotiated financing, lease, and major vendor/subcontractor terms; currently lead development, construction, experience production, and launch of the first location.
- Served as Executive Producer for development of an immersive Superman experience in collaboration with Warner Bros., coordinating creative, technical, and experience-development disciplines.
- Lead strategy, development, and executive production for immersive, location-based, interactive, and hospitality experiences for entertainment and cultural organizations.
- Serve as senior client counterpart and trusted advisor throughout development and delivery, balancing creative ambition, commercial realities, project risk, and execution; develop commercial strategies and negotiate client budgets, scopes, staffing plans, and subcontractor/vendor terms.
- Additional current and previous collaborations include the National Cowboy & Western Heritage Museum and Secret Cinema.

SELECTED EXECUTIVE OPERATING ROLES

Wynn Resorts – Vice President, Onsite Interactive Customer Experience **2023 to 2024**

- Led strategy for transforming the onsite guest experience through new experiential, digital, and interactive capabilities at Wynn Las Vegas.
- Built alignment with operating Vice Presidents and Senior Directors across resort operations, technology, data science, CRM, vendors, and executive stakeholders to identify and advance transformation opportunities.
- Translated guest and operating needs into experience concepts, product roadmaps, and implementation approaches grounded in guest value and operational realities.

Hunt A Killer – Vice President, Product, Growth & Business Development **2022 to 2023**

- Led development of the company's location-based entertainment portfolio while expanding responsibility across product, growth, business development, and marketing.
- Served as Executive Producer for live, location-based murder-mystery and immersive entertainment concepts.
- Led project management, product development, and game design across subscription products, premium collections, retail and tabletop games, multiplayer experiences, digital products, and live entertainment.
- Led marketing and sales initiatives that drove record Q4 revenue in 2022, following strong growth across Q2 and Q3.

Carnival Corporation – Vice President, Design & Development **2018 to 2022**

Senior Director, Research, Development & Integration | 2016 to 2017

- Assumed end-to-end project-delivery leadership for Princess MedallionClass during a critical stage of the program, stabilizing execution and leading the organization through fleet-wide implementation and continued evolution.
- Directed delivery of an approximately \$1B capital transformation program spanning the entire Princess Cruises fleet, integrating physical environments, technology, hospitality operations, entertainment, commerce, guest services, and digital experiences.

- Led and developed a multidisciplinary delivery organization numbering in the hundreds at peak, working directly with project leaders and teams to resolve complex issues, strengthen execution, and maintain alignment from senior leadership through frontline delivery. Led vendor contract negotiations across scope, staffing, budgets, commercial terms, and delivery commitments.
- Oversaw implementation and deployment across thousands of service points throughout the Princess fleet, spending extended periods aboard ships to evolve the platform with new guest experiences, operational capabilities, and product extensions in real operating conditions.
- Built executive sponsorship for new experience and capital programs, developing business cases and presenting directly to the CEO and senior corporate leadership to secure funding, staffing, and organizational support for initiatives including Alaska destination expansion, Caribbean cruise-port development, cruise-terminal expansion, new ship experiences, and emerging guest-experience concepts.
- Helped establish the guiding experience principles for Sun Princess, with teams under my organization subsequently responsible for execution and delivery of major elements of the program.
- Developed financial plans, project roadmaps, prototypes, investment cases, and executive presentations used to evaluate future capital programs and portfolio expansion.

DISNEY CREATIVE & EXPERIENCE LEADERSHIP

Walt Disney Imagineering – Principal / Portfolio Leadership Roles 2011 to 2016

- Progressed through Manager and Principal roles spanning New Experiences R&D, guest-facing interactive portfolio leadership, and concept development while leading delivery of major interactive and immersive attractions across Walt Disney Parks & Resorts.
- Built a reputation for stabilizing technically and organizationally challenging programs, clarifying the experience and delivery approach, aligning teams, and driving implementation; Test Track was an early example.
- Led and contributed to major portfolios including MagicBand and personalized park experiences; Star Wars, including Millennium Falcon: Smugglers Run; interactive and personalized attraction scenes; Innoventions; and Marvel development.
- Acted as an internal portfolio advocate for programs ranging from approximately \$80K to \$400M, cultivating senior stakeholder sponsorship, developing business cases, and securing budget and staffing support needed to sustain teams and advance priority projects.
- Led multidisciplinary combinations of creative, design, engineering, software, game development, media, ride, show systems, operations, and production disciplines across domestic and international resorts.

The Walt Disney Company – Creative / Advanced Technology & R&D 2005 to 2011

Senior Manager, Walt Disney Studios Home Entertainment | 2007 to 2011

- Led creative and technical development of emerging digital entertainment platforms and interactive consumer experiences, including interactive television, web, gaming, content, and platform technologies.
- Led or contributed to Disney technology firsts including Disney BD-Live Network, DisneyFile Digital Copy, Disney Total Menus, and iTunes Extras.
- Guided early product, UX, and technology development for Disney Movies Anywhere and represented Disney with consumer-electronics manufacturers, software companies, entertainment studios, and industry standards organizations.
- Earlier roles (2005 to 2007) across Walt Disney Imagineering R&D, Buena Vista Games, and Walt Disney Parks & Resorts New Technology; selected work included Adventures by Disney, Living Characters Initiative, Disneyland game concepts, PhotoPass, and emerging digital-media initiatives.

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA — Master's Degree, Entertainment Technology

Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA — Bachelor of Science in Computer Science; Minor in Digital Media